
Test understanding, not just memory

HOW TO USE THE TEST

There are 40 repertoire-recall positions, ten structure questions and ten concrete tactical or opening decisions. Write the move, a reason and the opponent's best idea. The answer section follows all questions so you can print them separately.

SCORING

For each problem award one point for the selected move or a sound plan, one point for the explanation, and one point for identifying the opponent's threat or resource. Maximum: 180. Recall exercises can have other sound moves; the key gives the course choice.

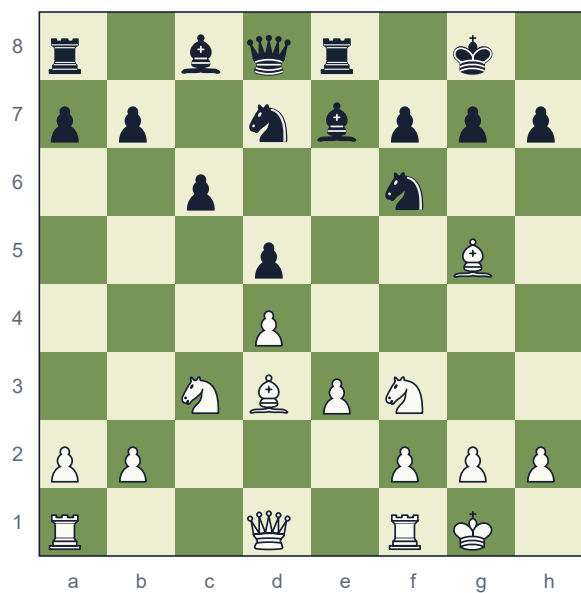
HONEST EVALUATION

This score is a study diagnostic, not an Elo estimate. Below 60 percent, revisit the core plans. Between 60 and 80 percent, repair missed branches. Above 80 percent, test retention through real games and delayed review.

TACTICAL PROBLEMS

For forcing problems, calculate to a clear result. In the Albin warning positions the side to move is Black. Do not answer with a plausible White developing move simply because this is a White repertoire course.

Exercises 01-02



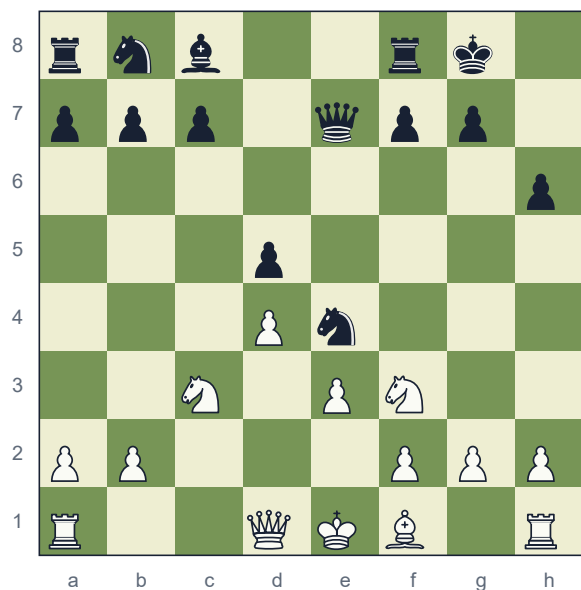
01. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



02. Repertoire recall

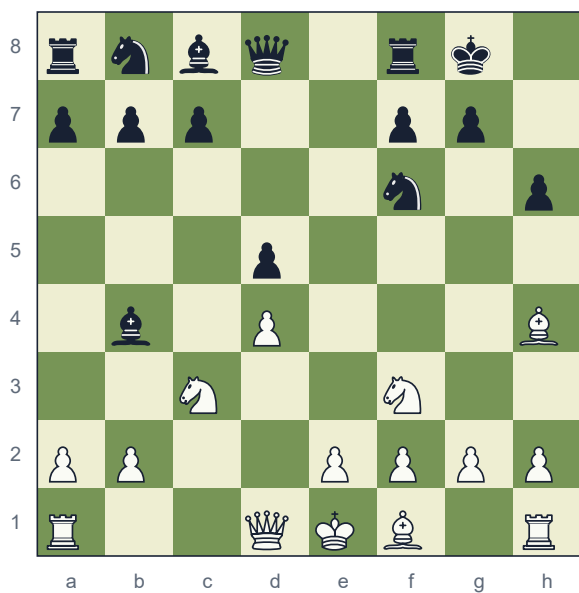
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 03-04



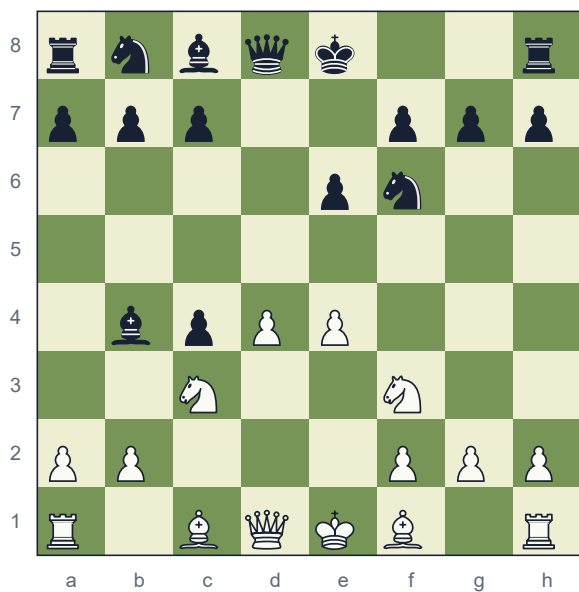
03. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



04. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 05-06

8

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

05. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

8

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

06. Repertoire recall

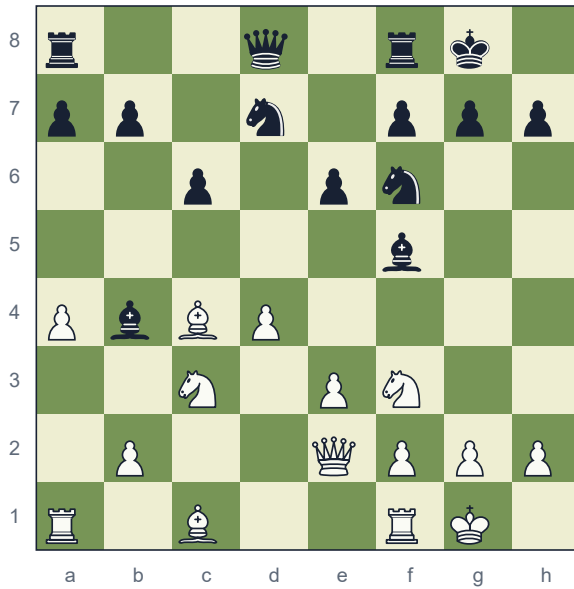
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 07-08



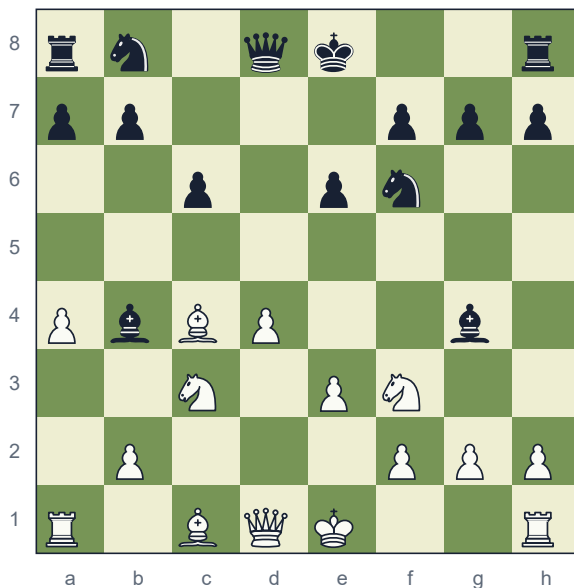
07. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



08. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 09-10

8

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

09. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

8

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

10. Repertoire recall

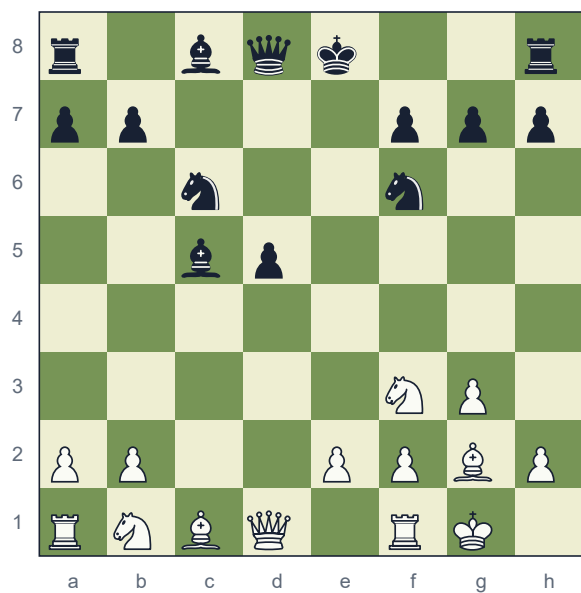
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 11-12



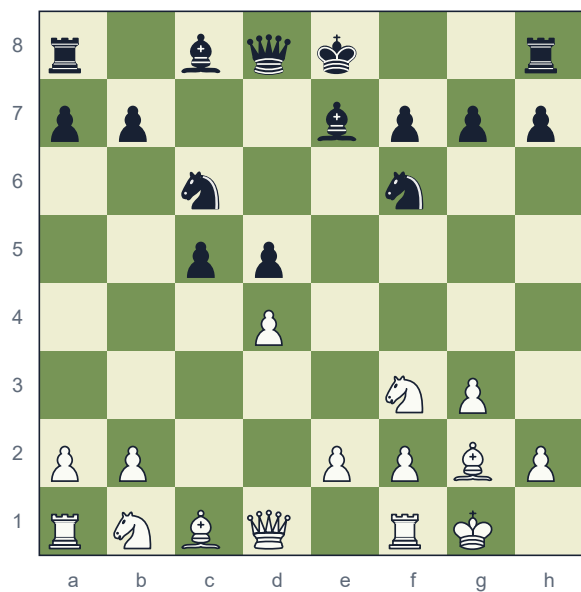
11. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



12. Repertoire recall

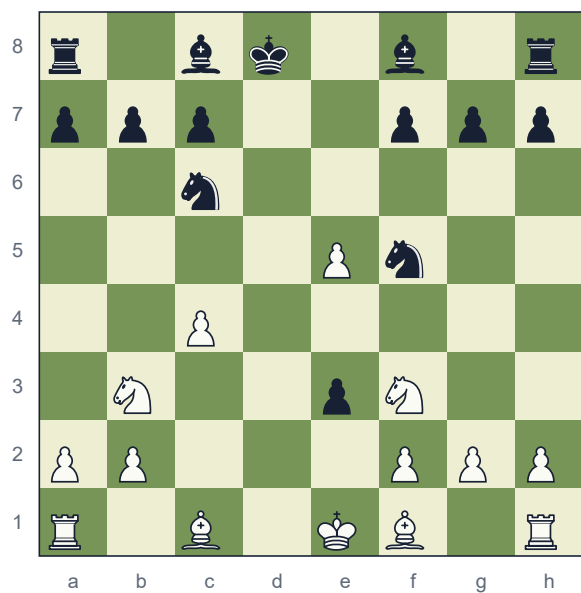
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 13-14



White to move

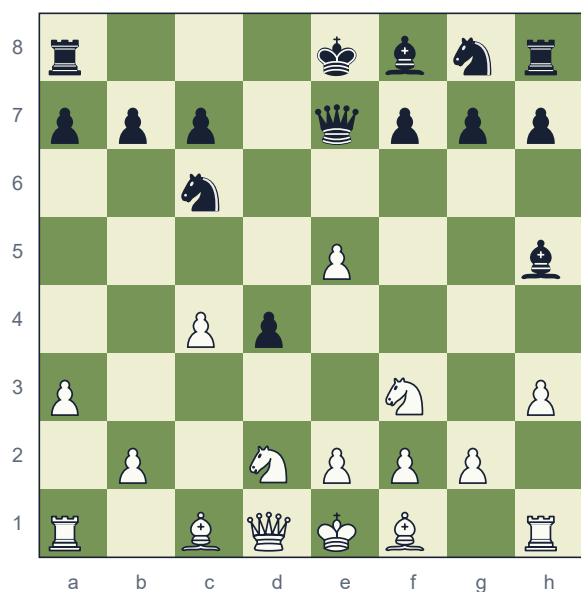
13. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

14. Repertoire recall

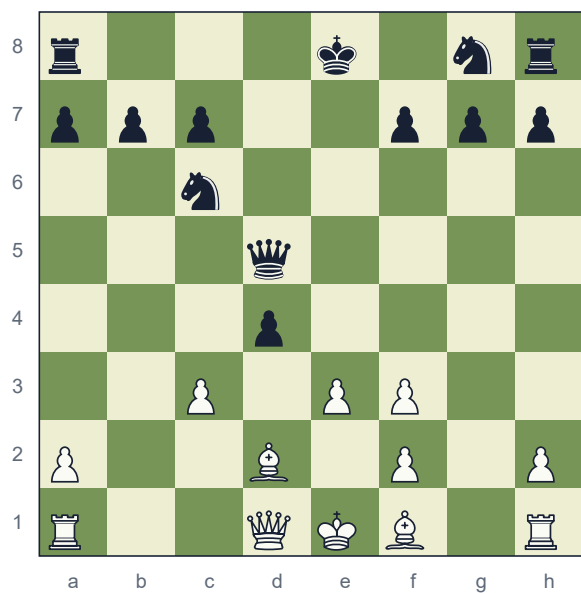
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 15-16



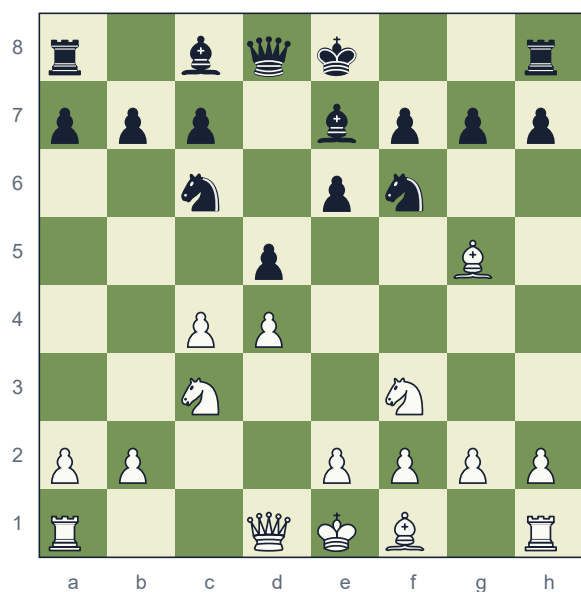
15. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



16. Repertoire recall

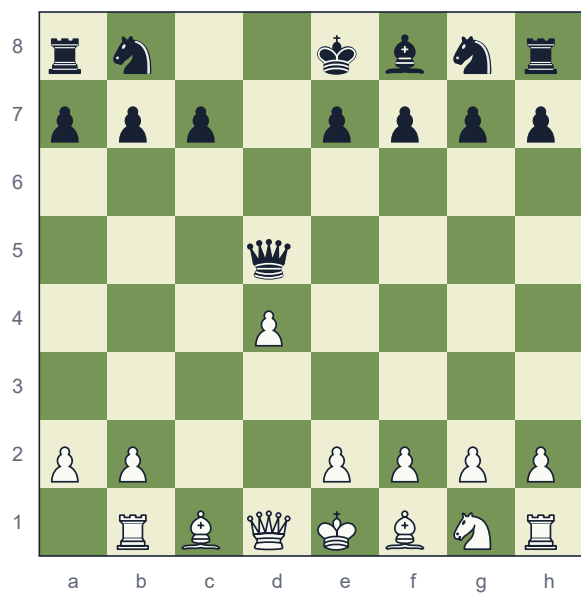
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 17-18



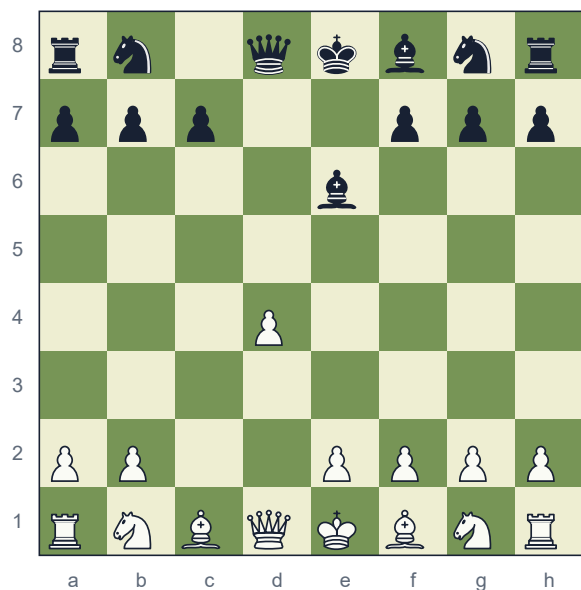
17. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



18. Repertoire recall

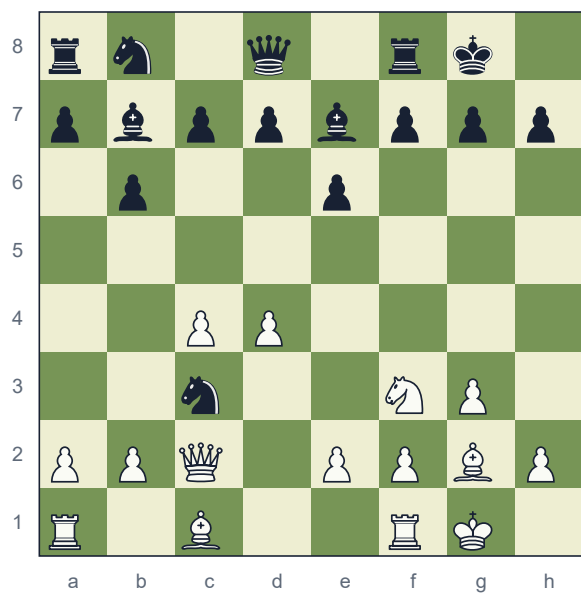
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 19-20



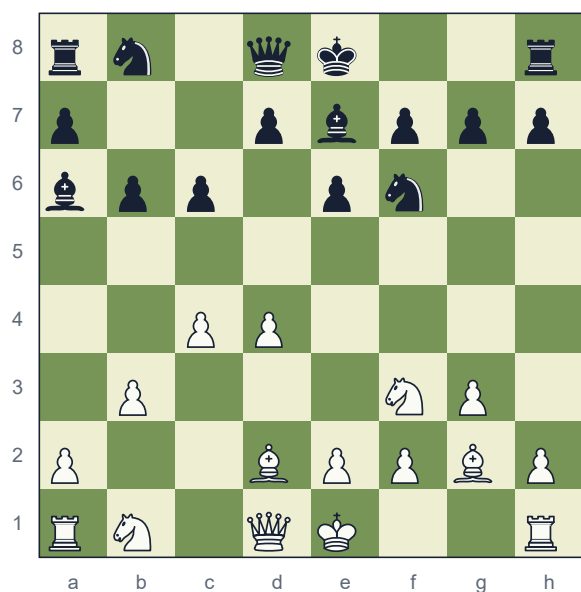
19. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



20. Repertoire recall

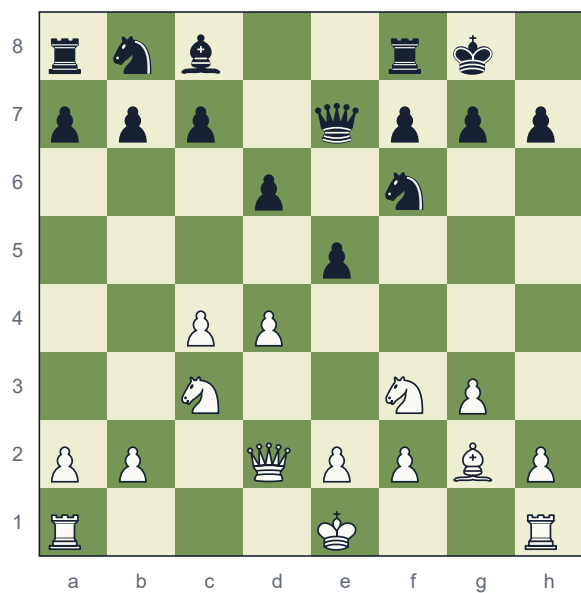
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 21-22



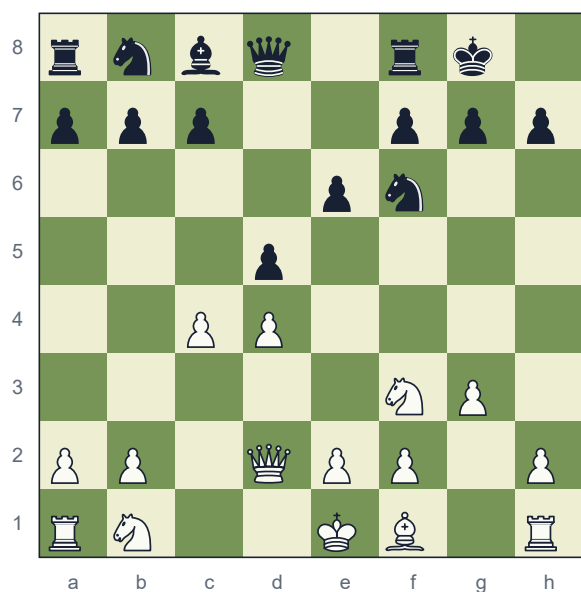
21. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



22. Repertoire recall

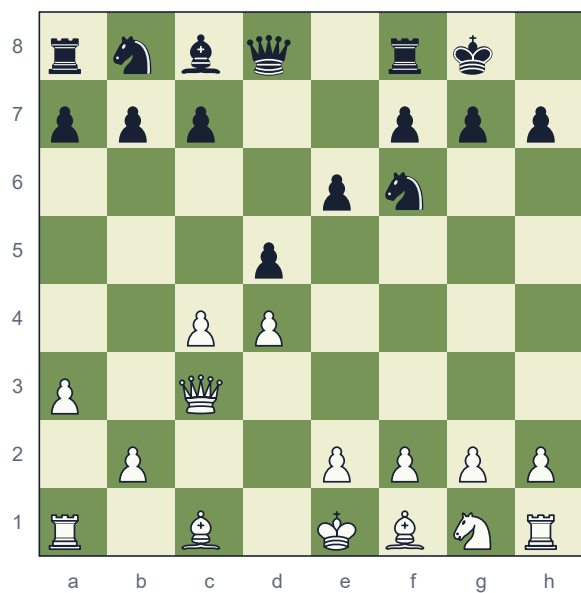
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 23-24



White to move

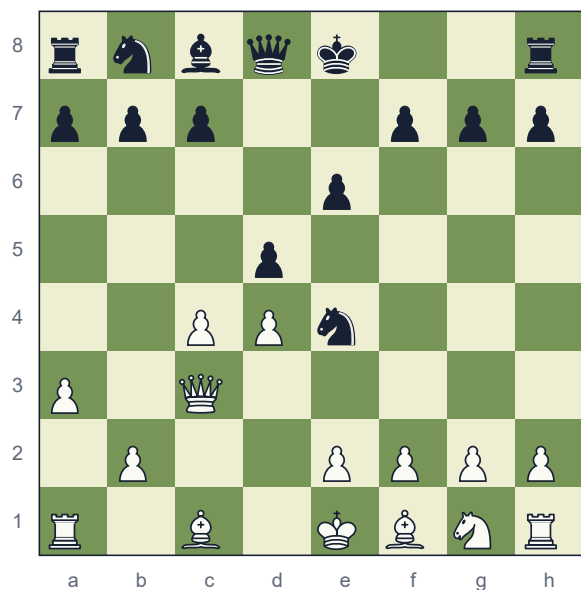
23. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

24. Repertoire recall

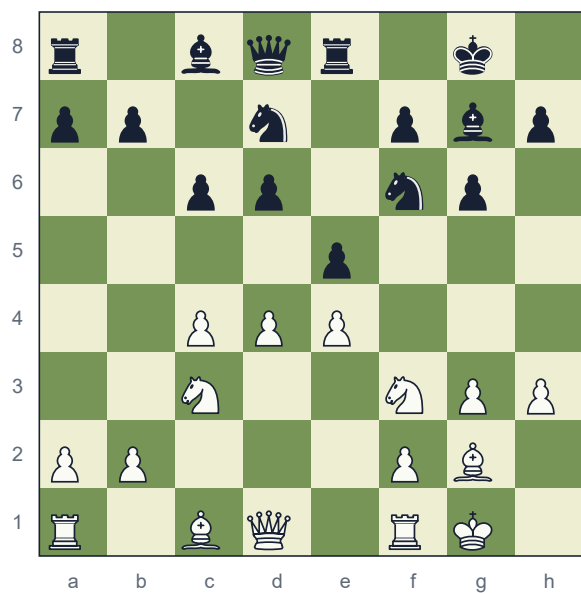
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 25-26



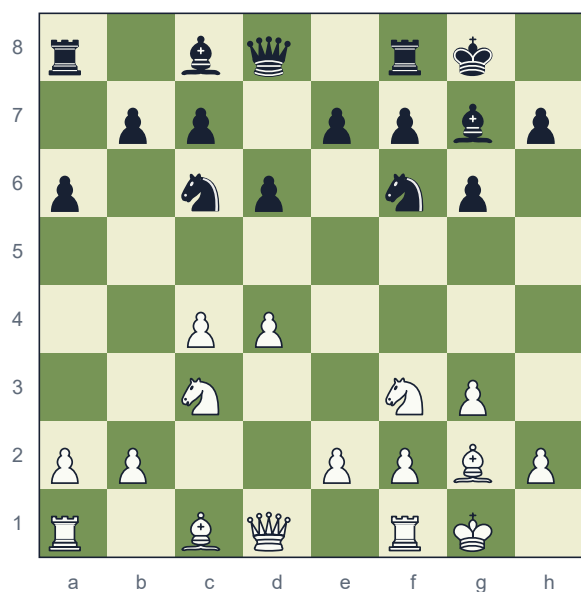
25. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



26. Repertoire recall

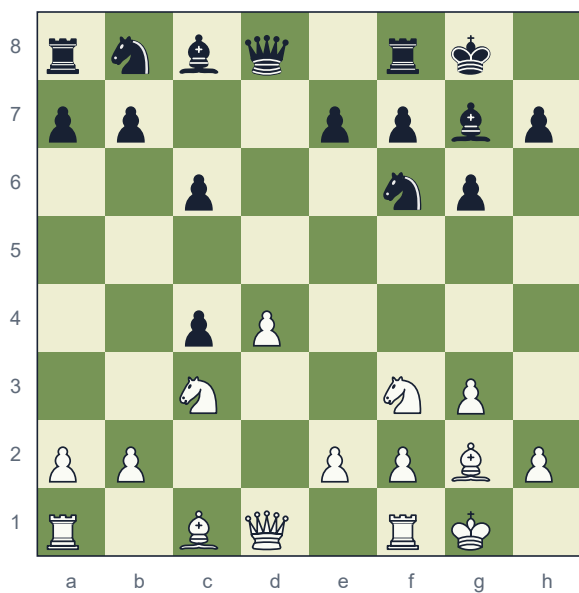
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 27-28



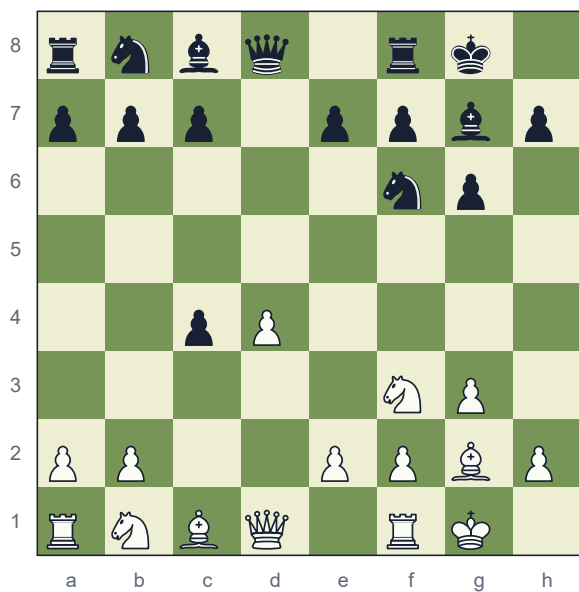
27. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



28. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

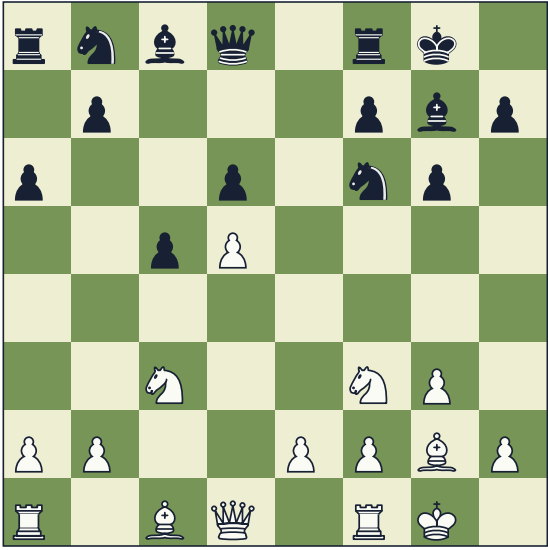
My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 29-30

8



a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

29. Repertoire recall

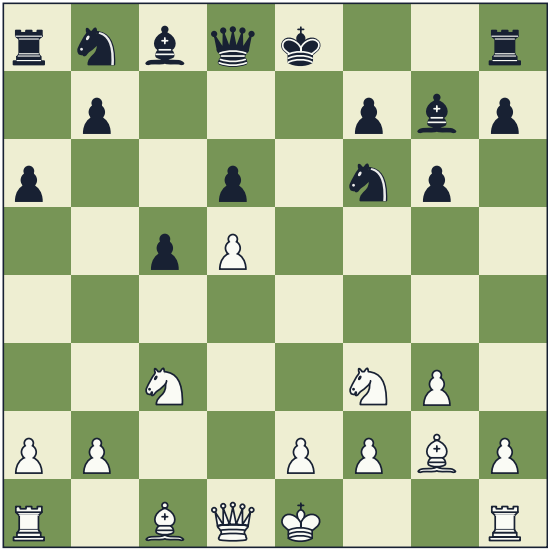
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

8



a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

30. Repertoire recall

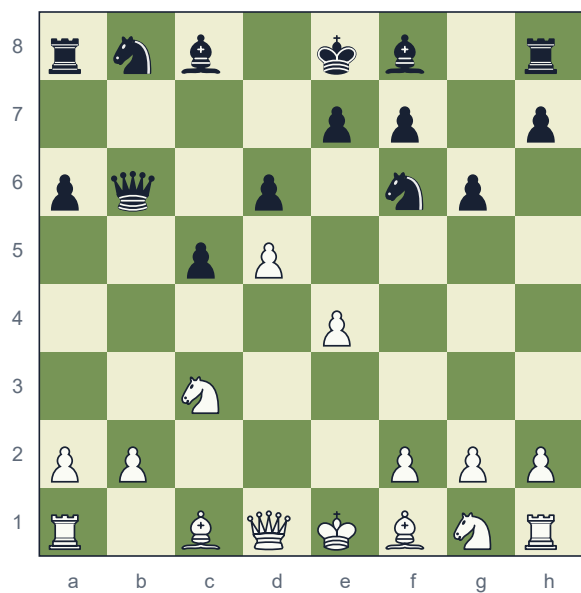
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 31-32



White to move

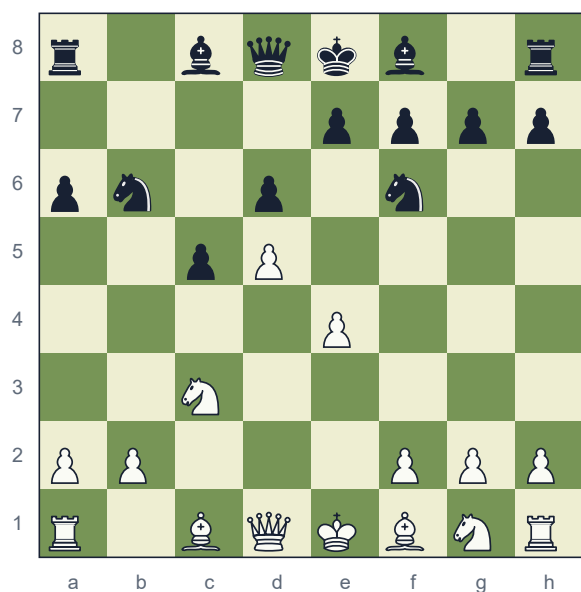
31. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

32. Repertoire recall

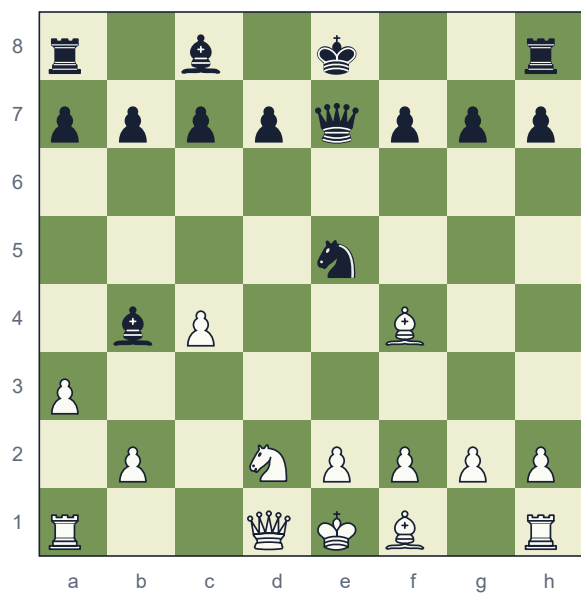
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 33-34



White to move

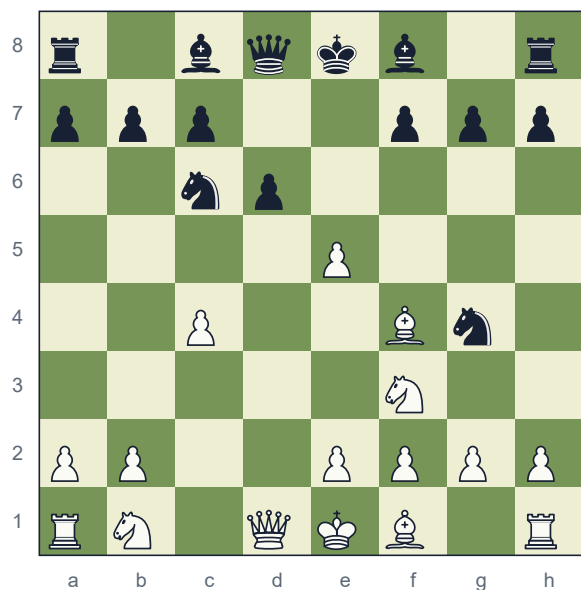
33. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

34. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

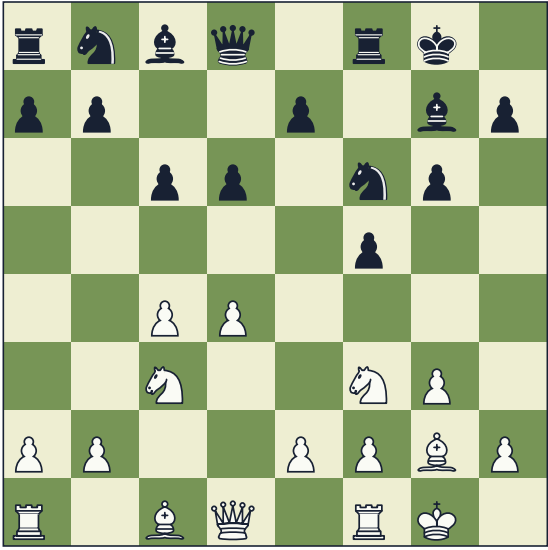
My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 35-36

8



a b c d e f g h

White to move

35. Repertoire recall

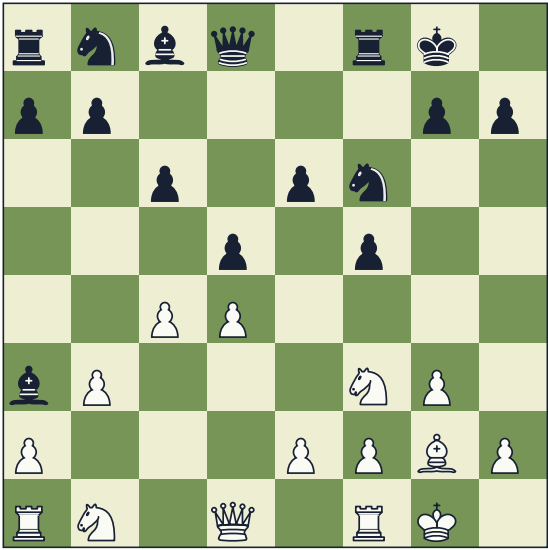
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

8



a b c d e f g h

White to move

36. Repertoire recall

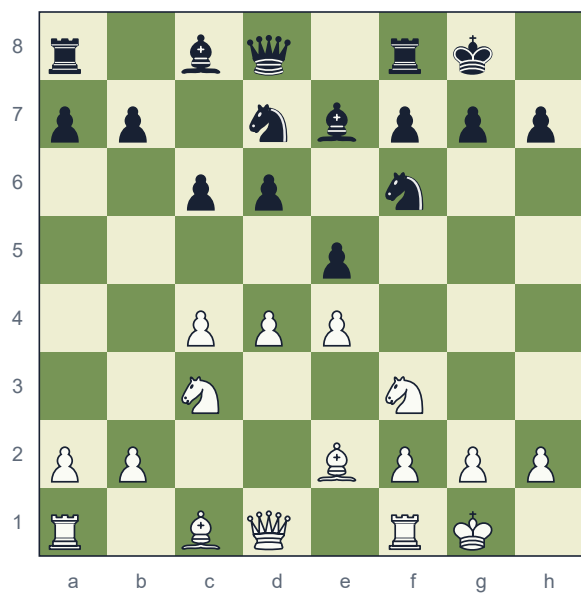
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 37-38



White to move

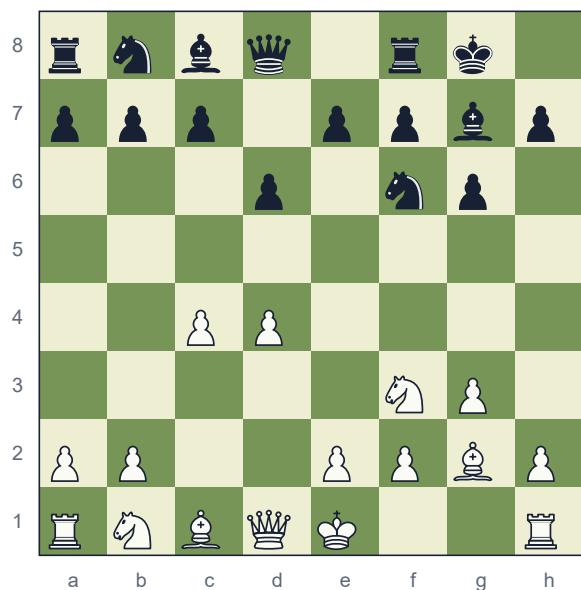
37. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

38. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 39-40

8

7

6

5

4

3

2

1

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

39. Repertoire recall

Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

8

7

6

5

4

3

2

1

a

b

c

d

e

f

g

h

White to move

40. Repertoire recall

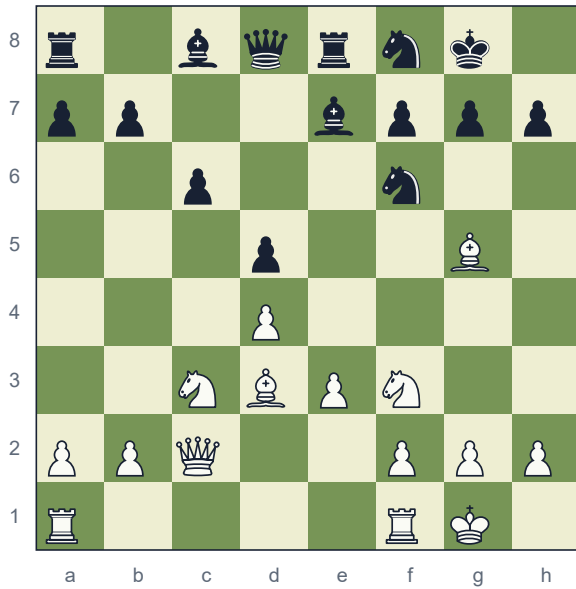
Choose the course move and explain its purpose.
Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 41-42



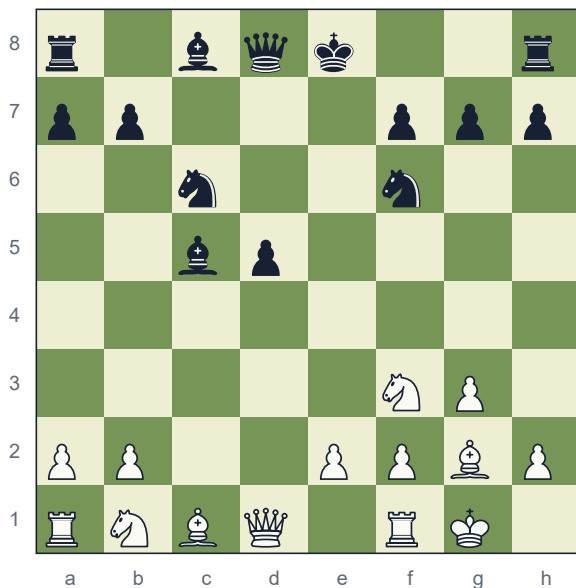
41. Plan and structure

Which piece needs improvement before b4? What exact pawn weakness would b5 create? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



42. Plan and structure

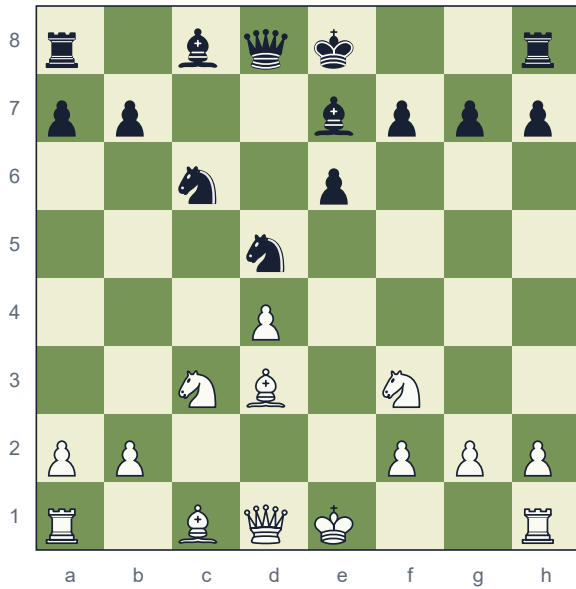
Which square is directly in front of the isolated pawn? Can you occupy it safely? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 43-44



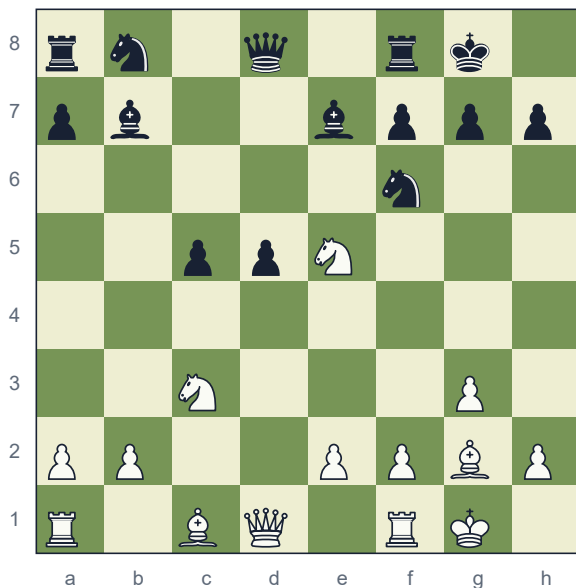
43. Plan and structure

Which trade favors the blockader? What would have to change for d5 to work? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



44. Plan and structure

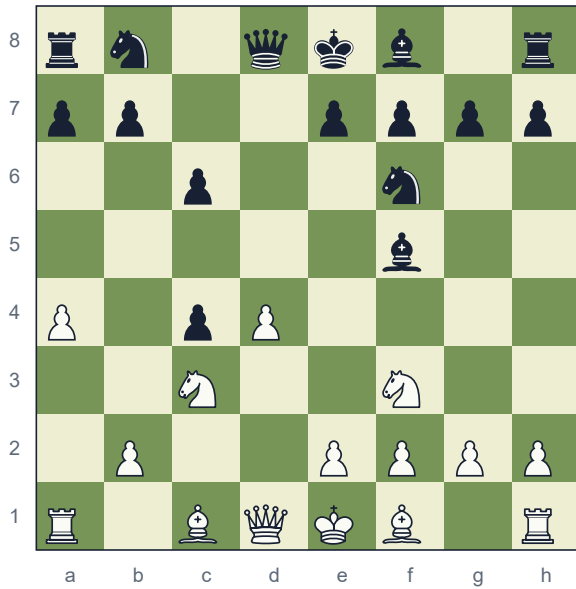
If ...d4 is played, which square and pawn become vulnerable? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 45-46



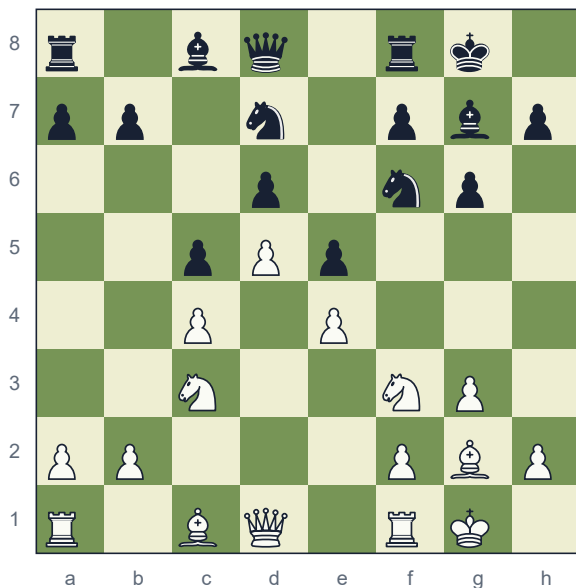
45. Plan and structure

Why does a4 matter here? Which move opens the bishop that can recover c4? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



46. Plan and structure

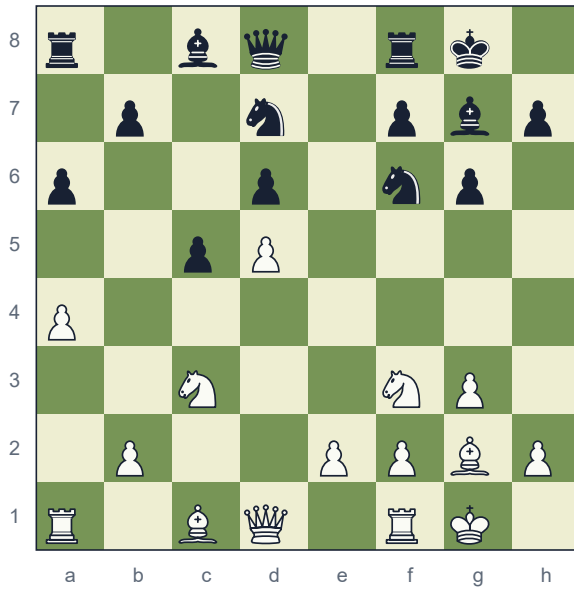
Which pawn break is realistic for each side? Which knight has the clearest route to a better square? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 47-48



White to move

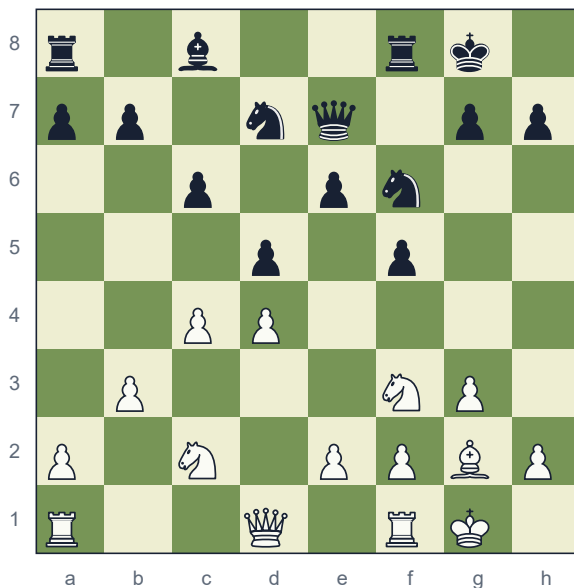
47. Plan and structure

Does a4 stop ...b5 permanently or only make it harder?
What supports an eventual e5 break? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

48. Plan and structure

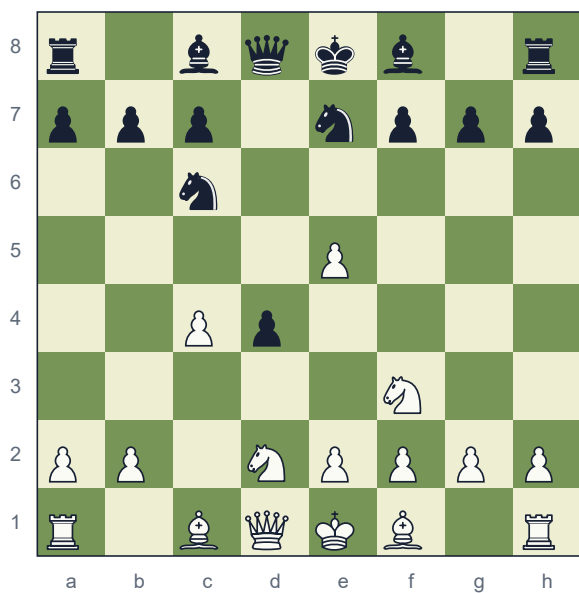
Which bishop would Black most like to improve? Which trade reduces the attack? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 49-50



White to move

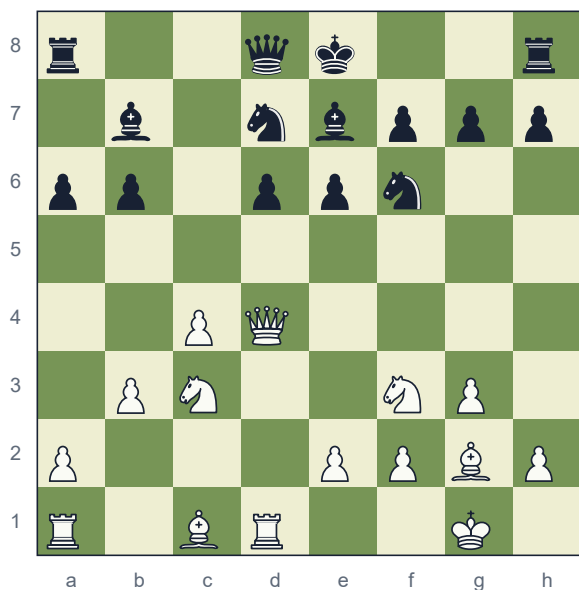
49. Plan and structure

What does Nb3 attack? Why is e3 tactically different from a quiet QGD e3 move? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

50. Plan and structure

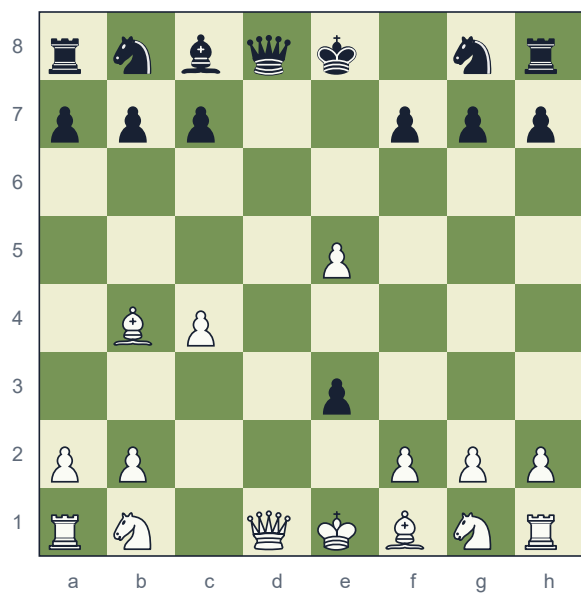
Which break would free Black's position? Can it be prevented usefully, or should you prepare to meet it? Name the structure and one resource for the other side.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 51-52



Black to move

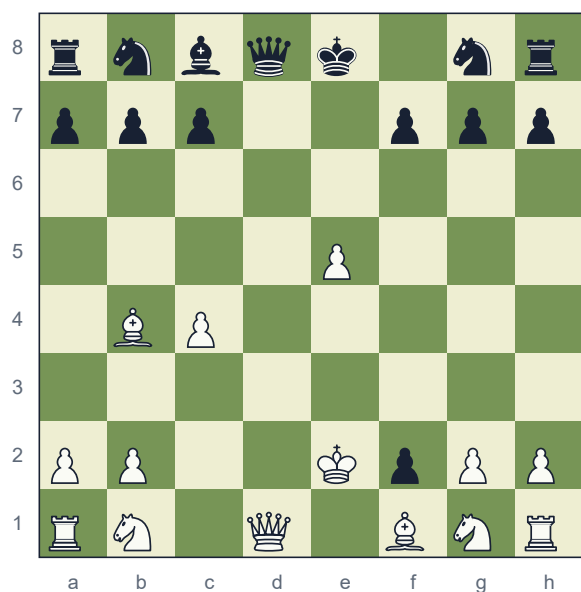
51. Tactical warning: Black to move

Find the forcing move. Why is capturing a bishop or promoting to a queen not the whole calculation?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



Black to move

52. Tactical warning: Black to move

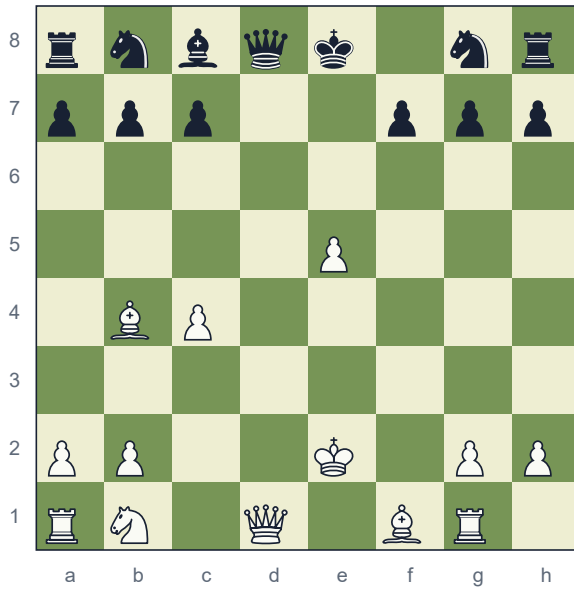
Find the forcing move. Why is capturing a bishop or promoting to a queen not the whole calculation?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 53-54



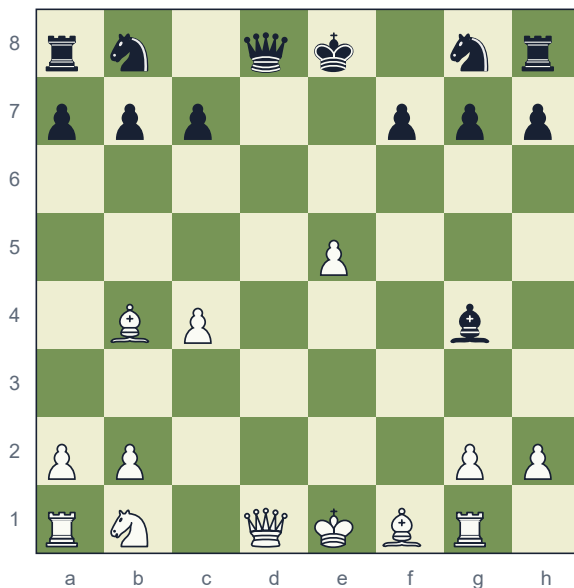
53. Tactical warning: Black to move

Find the forcing move. Why is capturing a bishop or promoting to a queen not the whole calculation?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



54. Tactical warning: Black to move

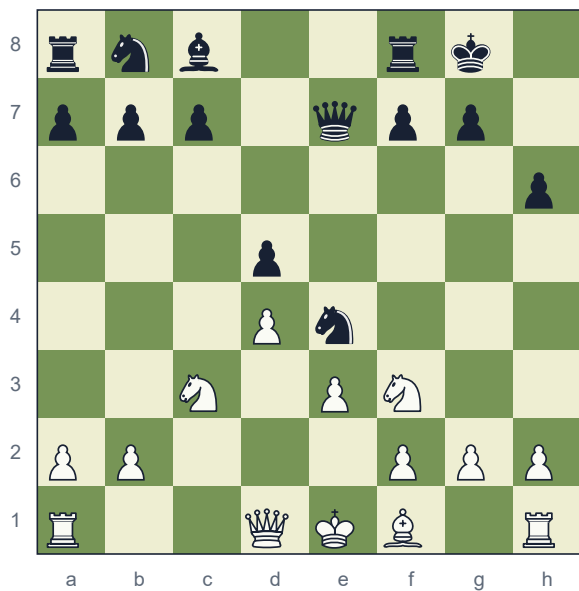
Find the forcing move. Why is capturing a bishop or promoting to a queen not the whole calculation?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 55-56



White to move

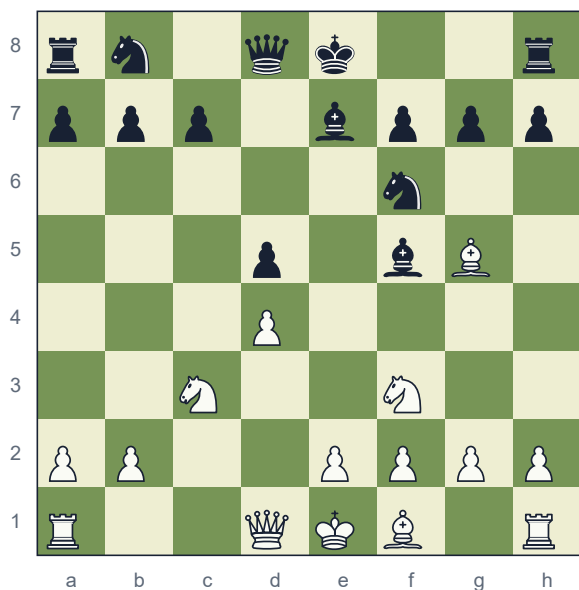
55. Concrete opening decision

A central pawn has lost a defender. Find the concrete opportunity.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

56. Concrete opening decision

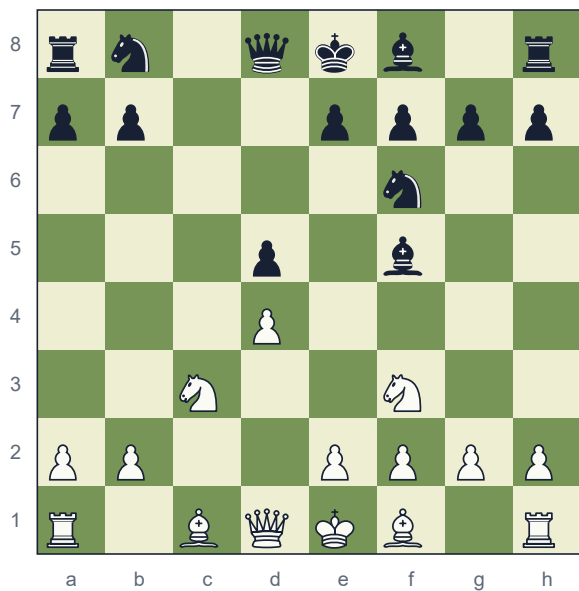
Which defender can White exchange to create pressure on d5?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 57-58



White to move

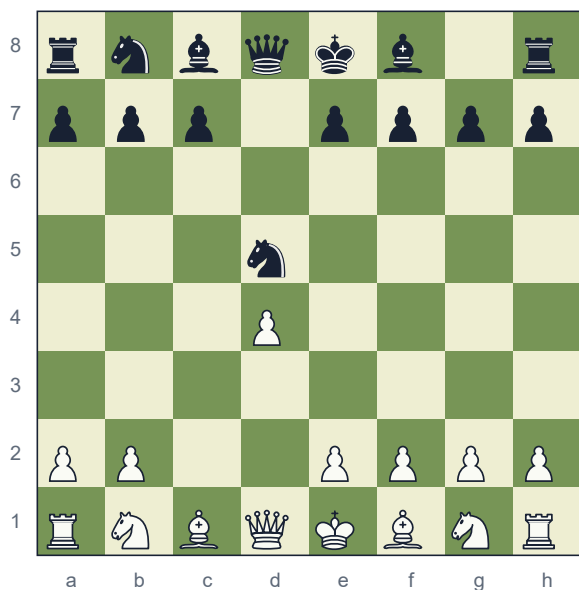
57. Concrete opening decision

Black developed the c8 bishop early. How can White create queenside pressure?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



White to move

58. Concrete opening decision

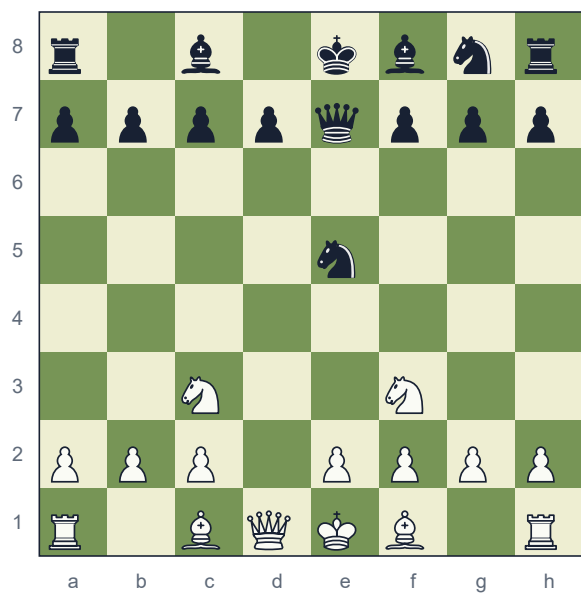
Gain central space with tempo against the knight.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Exercises 59-60



White to move

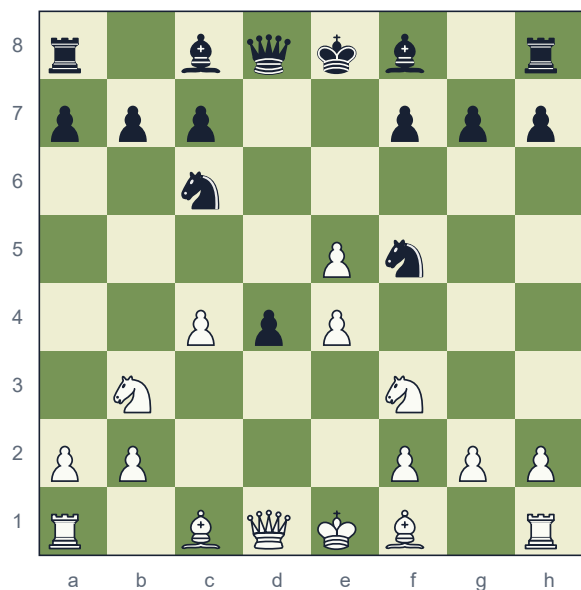
59. Concrete opening decision

The black queen is exposed. Find a developing attack on it.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:



Black to move

60. Concrete opening decision

Black can capture en passant. What is the move, and why is it legal?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

Opponent's reply:

Answers 01-03

01. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-01

Qc2. Coordinates the queen with central play while clearing d1 for a rook. cxd5 fixes a structure you can study repeatedly. Bg5 develops outside the e3 pawn chain; Bd3 points at h7 while supporting later central play.

Replay: 10. Qc2 Nf8

02. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-02

Nxd5. The knight captures on d5. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Bh4 keeps the pin available; when the knight reaches e4, exchanging on e7 simplifies the pressure on your bishop without abandoning development.

Replay: 10. Nxd5 Qd8

03. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-01

e3. Supports d4 and opens a diagonal for the f1 bishop. The exchange removes the tension before the pin generates more complications. Bg5 counter-pins the f6 knight and e3 prepares Bd3.

Replay: 8. e3 Bf5 9. Be2 Nbd7 10. Qb3 c5

Answers 04-06

04. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-02

Bg5. Develops the bishop and increases pressure along the diagonal toward f6 and d8. e4 uses the tempo Black spent capturing c4. The center gives space but becomes the target of ...c5 and ...Nxe4 ideas.

Replay: 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bxf6 Qxf6 8. Bxc4 c5 9. O-O cxd4 10. e5 Qd8

05. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-01

Rd1. Places the rook on d1. Use the line explanation below to connect that placement to the center and opponent's threats. e3 opens the bishop and Bxc4 recovers the pawn with development. Qe2 and Rd1 build pressure on the central file.

Replay: 9. Rd1 Nbd7 10. e4 cxd4

06. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-02

e3. Supports d4 and opens a diagonal for the f1 bishop. a4 attacks the base of Black's chain. After ...b4, e3 opens lines and prepares to recover c4.

Replay: 5. e3 Nf6 6. Bxc4 e6 7. a5 a6 8. O-O Bb7 9. Nbd2 Be7 10. Re1 O-O

Answers 07-09

07. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-01

e4. Gains central space and controls d5 and f5; check the concrete attacks on the new pawn. a4 restrains ...b5, e3 releases the bishop, and e4 later uses your central majority after development.

Replay: 10. e4 Bg6

08. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-02

O-O. Castling moves the king out of the center and brings a rook closer to the central files. The bishop pins f3 instead of controlling e4 from f5. You can still use the main development scheme.

Replay: 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Qb3 Qb6 10. Nd2 a5

09. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-01

e5. Places the pawn on e5. Use the line explanation below to connect that placement to the center and opponent's threats. White gains time against the f6 knight while Black attacks the center. This is a concrete line: e5 is a central reaction to ...c5, not a generic attacking move.

Replay: 10. e5 cxd4

Answers 10-12

10. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-02

Qc2. Coordinates the queen with central play while clearing d1 for a rook. Qc2 reinforces e4 while castling removes your king from the center. Both players retain choices about the central tension.

Replay: 8. Qc2 e5 9. cxd5 cxd5 10. e4 exd4

11. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-01

Nc3. Develops the queen knight and adds control of d5 and e4. The bishop on g2 attacks central dark squares. Exchanging d4xc5 can leave Black with an isolated d5 pawn.

Replay: 9. Nc3 O-O 10. a3 a5

12. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-02

Nc3. Develops the queen knight and adds control of d5 and e4. White can also maintain the central tension. Black's choice between ...cxd4, ...c4 and waiting changes where your counterplay belongs.

Replay: 8. Nc3 O-O 9. dxc5 Bxc5 10. a3 a5

Answers 13-15

13. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-01

fxe3. The pawn captures on e3. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Nbd2-b3 attacks d4. e4 challenges the knight and allows an en-passant capture; Qxd8+ first is essential to understand the resulting queenless position.

Replay: 9. fxe3 a5 10. Bd3 Bb4+

14. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-02

Qa4. Places the queen on a4. Use the line explanation below to connect that placement to the center and opponent's threats. a3 prevents ...Bb4+; h3 asks the bishop to choose. Qa4 creates queenside pressure while Black spends time placing the queen on e7.

Replay: 8. Qa4 O-O-O 9. g4 Bg6 10. Bg2 Kb8

15. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-01

cxd4. The pawn captures on d4. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Black gives up bishops to damage your pawns. White accepts a broad center and the bishop pair; e3 supports development and the d4 square.

Replay: 10. cxd4 Nge7

Answers 16-18

16. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-02

e3. Supports d4 and opens a diagonal for the f1 bishop. Black has chosen a solid setup with the c-pawn blocked. Ordinary development gives you a comfortable central position.

Replay: 6. e3 O-O 7. Rc1 h6 8. Bf4 Bd6 9. Bg3 Bxg3 10. hxg3 Qe7

17. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-01

Nf3. Develops the king knight and influences the central d4 and e5 squares. The rook recapture keeps your king and queen safe. Black recovers d5 but has exchanged an active bishop for your knight.

Replay: 5. Nf3 Nf6 6. a3 Nc6 7. e3 e5 8. dxe5 Qxd1+ 9. Kxd1 Ng4 10. Ke2 Ngxe5

18. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-02

Nf3. Develops the king knight and influences the central d4 and e5 squares. White accepts another central pawn while letting Black develop. The extra pawn must be balanced against the time spent capturing.

Replay: 5. Nf3 Nf6 6. Nc3 Bb4 7. Bd2 c5 8. a3 cxd4 9. axb4 dxc3 10. Bxc3 Qe7

Answers 19-21

19. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-01

Qxc3. The queen captures on c3. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Qc2 supports central play and the queen recapture preserves your pawns. Black exchanges a useful knight but reduces White's control of e4.

Replay: 9. Qxc3 d6 10. Qd3 f5

20. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-02

O-O. Castling moves the king out of the center and brings a rook closer to the central files. b3 defends c4. Bd2 interposes against the check and makes ...Bb4+ a manageable part of the move order.

Replay: 8. O-O d5 9. Qc2 O-O 10. Rd1 Nbd7

21. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-01

O-O. Castling moves the king out of the center and brings a rook closer to the central files. The queen recapture preserves the b1 knight's choice of square. g3 and Bg2 provide a compact developing scheme.

Replay: 9. O-O Re8 10. h3 a5

Answers 22-24

22. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-02

Bg2. Completes the kingside fianchetto and prepares or supports a castled king setup. The check has led to an early bishop exchange. You can still use the fianchetto while keeping d4 and c4 in the center.

Replay: 7. Bg2 c6 8. O-O dxc4 9. a4 b5 10. axb5 cxb5

23. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-01

Nf3. Develops the king knight and influences the central d4 and e5 squares. a3 asks the bishop to decide; Qxc3 preserves the pawn structure. Nf3 brings another piece into the center.

Replay: 7. Nf3 Nbd7 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 c5 10. e3 b6

24. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-02

Qc2. Coordinates the queen with central play while clearing d1 for a rook. The queen retreats after the knight gains time. You have preserved the structure, but Black has obtained active central play.

Replay: 7. Qc2 O-O 8. Nf3 Nd7 9. e3 b6 10. Bd3 Bb7

Answers 25-27

25. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-01

Be3. Places the bishop on e3. Use the line explanation below to connect that placement to the center and opponent's threats. The center is supported by pieces before e4. h3 restricts ...Bg4 and gives the king position a little flexibility.

Replay: 10. Be3 exd4

26. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-02

h3. Controls g4 and can restrict or question a black minor piece on that square. Black prepares queenside expansion. h3 is a useful waiting move but does not by itself stop ...b5.

Replay: 8. h3 Rb8 9. e4 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

27. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 15-01

a4. Controls b5 and challenges Black's queenside pawn expansion. a4 restrains ...b5 and prepares to recover the pawn without allowing a lasting queenside chain.

Replay: 8. a4 Nd5 9. Bd2 Bf5 10. b3 cxb3

Answers 28-30

28. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 15-02

Qc2. Coordinates the queen with central play while clearing d1 for a rook. Qc2 eyes c4 and keeps the center supported. Black must decide how much effort to spend holding the extra pawn.

Replay: 7. Qc2 Nc6 8. Qxc4 Be6 9. Qa4 Nd5 10. Nc3 Nb6

29. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-01

a4. Controls b5 and challenges Black's queenside pawn expansion. a4 makes ...b5 harder to achieve. The g2 bishop supports the center while the king reaches safety.

Replay: 10. a4 Nbd7

30. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-02

O-O. Castling moves the king out of the center and brings a rook closer to the central files. White need not delay king safety just because Black does. The center and ...b5 remain the strategic questions.

Replay: 9. O-O O-O 10. a4 Re8

Answers 31-33

31. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-01

Nf3. Develops the king knight and influences the central d4 and e5 squares. White has returned material but kept central space. The queen on b6 can become a target for useful developing moves.

Replay: 8. Nf3 Bg7 9. Be2 O-O 10. Nd2 Qd8

32. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-02

Nf3. Develops the king knight and influences the central d4 and e5 squares. The knight route costs time but develops a useful piece. White uses the time to occupy the center.

Replay: 8. Nf3 g6 9. h3 Bg7 10. a4 a5

33. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-01

e3. Supports d4 and opens a diagonal for the f1 bishop. Nbd2 answers the check and supports development. After the central exchanges, e3 opens the f1 bishop without weakening the king.

Replay: 9. e3 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 d6

Answers 34-36

34. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-02

exd6. The pawn captures on d6. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Black returns to straightforward development. The e5 pawn disappears, but White can maintain a healthy position.

Replay: 6. exd6 Bxd6 7. Bxd6 cxd6 8. e3 Be6 9. Nc3 Nf6 10. Be2 d5

35. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-01

d5. Gains space and controls c6 and e6; the resulting central pawn structure determines the next plan. White castles before confronting the center. d5 gains space and asks how Black will organize ...e5.

Replay: 8. d5 cxd5 9. Nxd5 e5 10. Bg5 Nc6

36. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-02

Nxa3. The knight captures on a3. Check the resulting recapture, pawn structure and open lines before applying the longer-term plan. Ba3 challenges the good d6 bishop. The knight recapture develops a piece that may head toward c2 and e5.

Replay: 9. Nxa3 Qe7 10. Nc2 Nbd7

Answers 37-39

37. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-01

Be3. Places the bishop on e3. Use the line explanation below to connect that placement to the center and opponent's threats. The broad center is supported by development. Black is compact and will seek a freeing pawn break.

Replay: 8. Be3 Ng4 9. Bd2 Ngf6 10. Qc2 Re8

38. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-02

O-O. Castling moves the king out of the center and brings a rook closer to the central files. The delayed knight move transposes to the fianchetto King's Indian. You have avoided introducing an unrelated e4-opening repertoire.

Replay: 6. O-O Bf5 7. Re1 a5 8. Nc3 Ne4 9. h4 Nc6 10. h5 e5

39. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 21-01

Nd5. Places the knight actively on d5 with an attack on the opposing queen. Nc3 develops while defending the center. After ...Nxe5, Nd5 attacks the queen with tempo and disrupts Black's intended setup.

Replay: 5. Nd5 Nxf3+ 6. gxf3 Qd8 7. Bf4 d6 8. Qd4 c6 9. Nc3 Be6 10. O-O-O Nf6

Answers 40-42

40. REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 21-02

Nc3. Develops the queen knight and adds control of d5 and e4. White accepts material but helps Black develop a bishop. Your response must be efficient development, not further pawn collecting.

Replay: 5. Nc3 Nf6 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 Bf5 8. e3 g5 9. Bg3 Bxg3 10. hxg3 g4

41. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / CARLSBAD AND THE MINORITY ATTACK

The c-file is half-open for White and the black c6 pawn can become a target after b4-b5. Your queenside minority tries to create a weakness, not a passed pawn immediately. Coordinate a rook on b1 or c1, prepare b4, and assess b5. If ...cxb5, examine the isolated d-pawn or weak c-file squares; if ...c5, recalculate the central structure. Black: Black seeks ...Ne4, kingside activity and the freeing ...c5. If those threats are urgent, a slow pawn plan may be too slow.

42. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / PLAYING AGAINST AN ISOLATED QUEEN PAWN

Black's d-pawn has no friendly c- or e-pawn to support it. It controls central squares, so it is not simply a free target. Restrain its advance, blockade with a suitable piece, and exchange active attacking pieces when favorable. Attack the pawn only after your king and pieces are coordinated. Black: Black wants ...d4 or an initiative before the position simplifies. A poorly timed pawn capture can release all of Black's pieces.

Answers 43-45

43. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / PLAYING WITH AN ISOLATED QUEEN PAWN

White has an isolated d4 pawn and open central lines. The pawn offers space and activity but can become an endgame burden. Use active bishops and rooks, keep useful attacking pieces, and prepare d5 if it opens the position favorably. Make the opponent defend threats before they can blockade. Black: Black wants a stable blockade and favorable piece exchanges. Avoid trading into a passive ending simply because it reduces the material.

44. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / HANGING PAWNS: C5 AND D5

The adjacent black c5 and d5 pawns lack friendly pawns on the neighboring outer files. Together they control useful central squares; after one advances, the other may become weak. For the side facing them, pressure both pawns and provoke a concession without allowing a strong advance. For the side owning them, keep activity and choose the right moment to push. Black: One careless exchange can turn the pair into a strong passed pawn rather than a weakness. Calculate recaptures before celebrating a structural target.

45. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / SLAV: THE CAPTURED C4 PAWN

Black has captured on c4 and White has played a4. The immediate structural battle concerns whether ...b5 can hold the extra pawn. Develop e3 and Bxc4 when safe. Do not replace useful development with queen moves just to regain the pawn one move sooner. Black: Black can counter in the center while you recover c4. The later e4 break must be supported against pins and exchanges.

Answers 46-48

46. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / THE LOCKED INDIAN CENTER

White's d5 and e4 pawns face Black's d6 and e5 pawns. The center is closed, but pawn breaks can reopen it. Improve the least active minor piece and identify a useful break. Queenside space is valuable only if it creates entry squares or targets. Keep the fianchetto bishop's defensive role in mind. Black: Black can prepare kingside activity or queenside breaks. The exact knight placements decide whether ...f5 or ...b5 is feasible.

47. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / MODERN BENONI: CENTRAL SPACE VERSUS ...B5

White's d5 pawn cramps Black. Black has a queenside majority and a potentially weak d6 pawn, compensated by active diagonals and files. Restrain ...b5 when useful, develop, and prepare e4-e5. Watch whether exchanging a key bishop would weaken your control of central squares. Black: Black seeks ...b5, ...Re8 and pressure against the center. The d6 pawn is rarely won by a single unsupported attack.

48. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / DUTCH STONEWALL: THE E5 SQUARE

The d5-e6-f5 chain gives Black space and restrains e4, but it leaves e5 as a potential white outpost and limits the c8 bishop. Challenge the good dark-squared bishop where possible. Maneuver a knight toward e5 only when the exchange consequences are favorable. Use patient piece improvement. Black: Black seeks ...Ne4 and attacking chances near your king. Do not create targets with unnecessary kingside pawn moves.

Answers 49-51

49. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / ALBIN: THE ADVANCED D4 WEDGE

The d4 pawn limits your pieces and creates tactics on e3 and along the d-file. White's extra e5 pawn does not remove those threats. Nbd2-b3 targets d4. Address pins first, and return material if needed to simplify safely. Know the en-passant detail in the e4 line. Black: Black seeks fast development, ...Bg4, and attacks while your king is central. Greedy bishop captures can allow a dangerous passed pawn.

50. PLAN AND STRUCTURE | SEE 22 / HEDGEHOG: RESPECT THE FREEING BREAK

Black keeps pawns on a6, b6, d6 and e6 behind compact pieces. White has more space, but that space can become vulnerable if overextended. Improve pieces and watch ...b5 and ...d5. Do not attack a compact position by creating more weak pawns than targets. Black: Black waits for a central or queenside break that activates several pieces at once. A quiet move may be a tactical preparation.

51. TACTICAL WARNING: BLACK TO MOVE | SEE 08-06

exf2+. The forcing sequence uses the passed pawn, knight underpromotion with check, and the exposed white king to win material. This is why the course avoids the early e3 trap.

Replay: 6... exf2+ 7. Ke2 fxg1=N+ 8. Rxd1 Bg4+ 9. Ke1 Bxd1 10. Nc3 Bg4

Answers 52-54

52. TACTICAL WARNING: BLACK TO MOVE | SEE 08-06

fxg1=N+. The forcing sequence uses the passed pawn, knight underpromotion with check, and the exposed white king to win material. This is why the course avoids the early e3 trap.

Replay: 7... fxg1=N+ 8. Rxg1 Bg4+ 9. Ke1 Bxd1 10. Nc3 Bg4

53. TACTICAL WARNING: BLACK TO MOVE | SEE 08-06

Bg4+. The forcing sequence uses the passed pawn, knight underpromotion with check, and the exposed white king to win material. This is why the course avoids the early e3 trap.

Replay: 8... Bg4+ 9. Ke1 Bxd1 10. Nc3 Bg4

54. TACTICAL WARNING: BLACK TO MOVE | SEE 08-06

Bxd1. The forcing sequence uses the passed pawn, knight underpromotion with check, and the exposed white king to win material. This is why the course avoids the early e3 trap.

Replay: 9... Bxd1 10. Nc3 Bg4

Answers 55-57

55. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 02-02

Nxd5. Bh4 keeps the pin available; when the knight reaches e4, exchanging on e7 simplifies the pressure on your bishop without abandoning development.

Replay: 10. Nxd5 Qd8

56. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 02-04

Bxf6. Exchanging the f6 knight removes a defender of d5. This concrete detail makes automatic e3 less ambitious in this exact position.

Replay: 7. Bxf6 Bxf6 8. Qb3 c6 9. Qxb7 Qb6 10. Qxb6 axb6

57. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 05-04

Qb3. The queen eyes b7 after the bishop has left c8. This makes Black account for the queenside instead of completing a setup for free.

Replay: 6. Qb3 Bc8 7. e4 Nxe4 8. Bb5+ Bd7 9. Qxd5 Nxc3 10. bxc3 Bxb5

Answers 58-60

58. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 10-03

e4. e4 builds a broad center with tempo against the knight. You gain space without chasing a queen around the board.

Replay: 4. e4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 6. dxe5 Qxd1+ 7. Kxd1 Ng4 8. Ke1 Bc5 9. f4 Nc6 10. Nd5 O-O

59. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 21-01

Nd5. Nc3 develops while defending the center. After ...Nxe5, Nd5 attacks the queen with tempo and disrupts Black's intended setup.

Replay: 5. Nd5 Nxf3+ 6. gxf3 Qd8 7. Bf4 d6 8. Qd4 c6 9. Nc3 Be6 10. O-O-O Nf6

60. CONCRETE OPENING DECISION | SEE 08-01

dxe3. Nbd2-b3 attacks d4. e4 challenges the knight and allows an en-passant capture; Qxd8+ first is essential to understand the resulting queenless position.

Replay: 7... dxe3 8. Qxd8+ Kxd8 9. fxe3 a5 10. Bd3 Bb4+